



Other manufacturers should follow Samsung's example and provide a three year warranty on their hard drives

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another model or pay the difference and buy a new hard disk.

As a last resort, you will be given a credit note, the value of which will be calculated on the basis of a similar hard disk available in the market and the age of your disk.

You will never be given a credit note for the actual amount you paid while buying the hard disk. You will also not be given a new hard disk under the warranty period unless the purchased hard disk fails to function from the first day itself, and that too has to be immediately reported back to the dealer. Since the

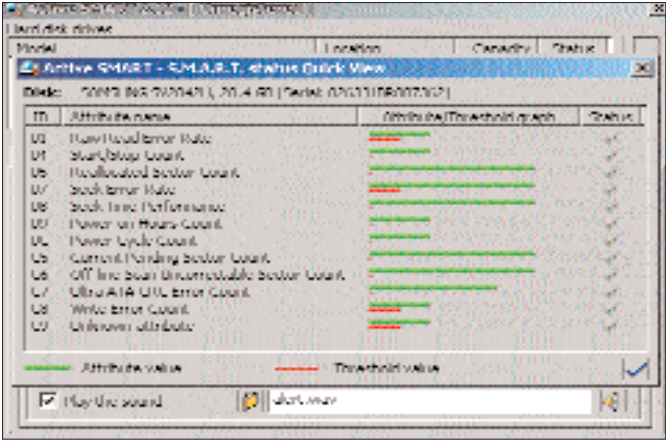
product is considered DOA (dead on arrival), you are liable for a fresh replacement.

Monitoring your hard disk's health

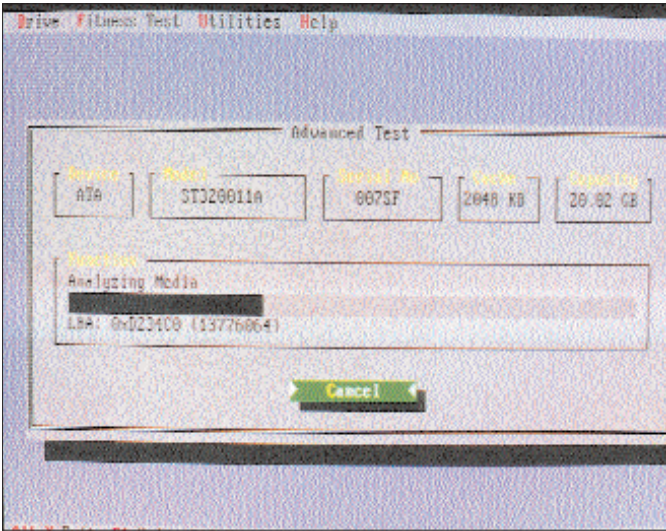
The first approach towards preventing a hard disk crash would be to activate the SMART facility from the BIOS. If your BIOS does not provide you with this facility, you should install programs such as Active Smart, Norton Disk Doctor, or Smart Defender, which continuously monitor hard disk activity and reduce the risk of your hard disk crashing by predicting disk failures using special algorithms. Such software usually monitor the performance of internal heads, motors and other critical components of the hard disk. They analyse the internal performance of the hard disk and constantly compare it with predefined threshold limits that are already programmed into them.

When the performance of the hard disk decreases or is not considered to be satisfactory enough for a normally functioning hard disk, it would be wise to promptly back up your data, as the hard disk could crash any time.

However, keep in mind that once you have enabled SMART, it will slow down the performance of your hard disk to a certain extent. This is because it continuously keeps scanning each and every time the disk reads or writes data.



Monitor your hard disk's health with Active SMART



The DFT utility analyses and repairs any errors on the hard disk

How Warranted is a Warranty

Your warranty is not applicable if:

- The product is not purchased from an authorised dealer.
- The product is not used according to instructions given in the instruction manual.
- Defects are caused by improper use as determined by the company personnel.
- Modification or alteration of any nature is made in the electrical circuitry or physical construction of the set.
- Installation or repair work is carried out by persons/agency other than those authorised by the company.
- You've kept the product in an unsuitable environment. The recommended temperature range for a drive is 60 degrees Centigrade.
- The original serial number has been removed, obliterated or altered from the machine or cabinet.
- There are defects due to causes beyond your control such as lightning, abnormal voltage, transportation losses, etc.

You can also run third party software from companies such as Seagate, IBM and Samsung, which also provide custom-made utilities that can diagnose hard disk problems. For example, IBM has a utility called DFT (Drive Fitness Test). This utility is a standalone software that runs in DOS mode and is independent of the end user's operating system.

Once you boot in the DOS mode, DFT can diagnose whether your drive is defective, has been damaged by voltage fluctuations, is about to fail soon and even tells you if it's running fine or you need a replacement.

So, before coming to a conclusion and sending your hard disk to the RMA centre for repairs you can run these utilities and do a self-check and try to repair the problems. This saves you the time and freight charges that you would otherwise have to bear.

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